



Eat Plastic

This "Food Generator" can turn plastic into an edible protein. Are you hungry? <http://digit.in/aug21-29>



Net neutrality reinstated in USA?

US President Biden signed an Executive Order with several provisions relating to net neutrality. <http://digit.in/aug21-30>

Talking to cars: Lost in translation?



Can we trust the bots
with our cars yet?
Maybe not just yet.

Satvik Pandey | feedback@digit.in

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ith cars getting smarter every day and companies like Tesla and Google investing heavily

towards the development of smart tech for cars, it is not long before the geeky Joe would be zooming down roads in automated electronic vehicles. Automated vehicles promise to make roads safer, at least in comparison to human drivers and are finding their way into vehicles in bits and pieces, such as drowsiness alerts and automated cruising modes. However the smart tech for cars on the roads today leave much to be

desired. There has been progress made, and the levels of it can be seen in the fact that even the simplest of sedans these days come with smart features such as parking assists and automatic emergency braking. There are certain kinks that need to be ironed out before we take the next big leap. Be it in the tech that enables automated commands which you can throw at your car to pull out the cup holder or letting it change lanes on the highway while you play the next mission of Cyberpunk on your car's infotainment system, all of it needs to be polished.

ANDROID AUTO AND THE VOICE COMMANDS

When Android Auto, one of the first true mass-market automation features or assistive companion to be better put, for vehicles were launched way back in the year 2015, which is 6 years ago, it was received well. It was mainly because the previous

attempts by other organizations had been underwhelming, and CarPlay by Apple was reserved at the time for the upper end of the car spectrum, with Ferrari, Mercedes-Benz, and Volvo being the first adopters of the tech.

But as time passed, competition grew, and so did people's reliance on these pieces of technology. Pretty soon, the users outgrew the innovation. As companies started rolling out features, with Android Auto by 2020 literally becoming like an Android device mounted on the insides of a car not requiring any phone or other such thing to function, the problems grew faster and faster. Amongst these was everything from privacy concerns to claims that drivers and passengers had their lives at stake because of the distractions caused by these features, which were meant to make everything safer. Come 2021, a



What do you play in your car?

year after Android Auto became an entity of its own inside a car, there are still problems cropping up right, left and centre for its developers. While Google did try to iron out some of the kinks, some persistent problems remain. As it turns out, the Google Assistant sometimes does not understand what you say to it while behind the wheel. It may be the simplest of instructions, but it won't do anything.